

It all starts with a data governance philosophy

Data governance can feel overwhelming, but having a clear path forward doesn't have to be daunting. Every data team is already doing some form of governance, and this template is designed to clarify that for you.

This is the starting point of building a greater philosophy.

Fill out the sections below to capture what's working for your team and where there are gaps so you can evolve it with clarity, confidence, and scale in mind.

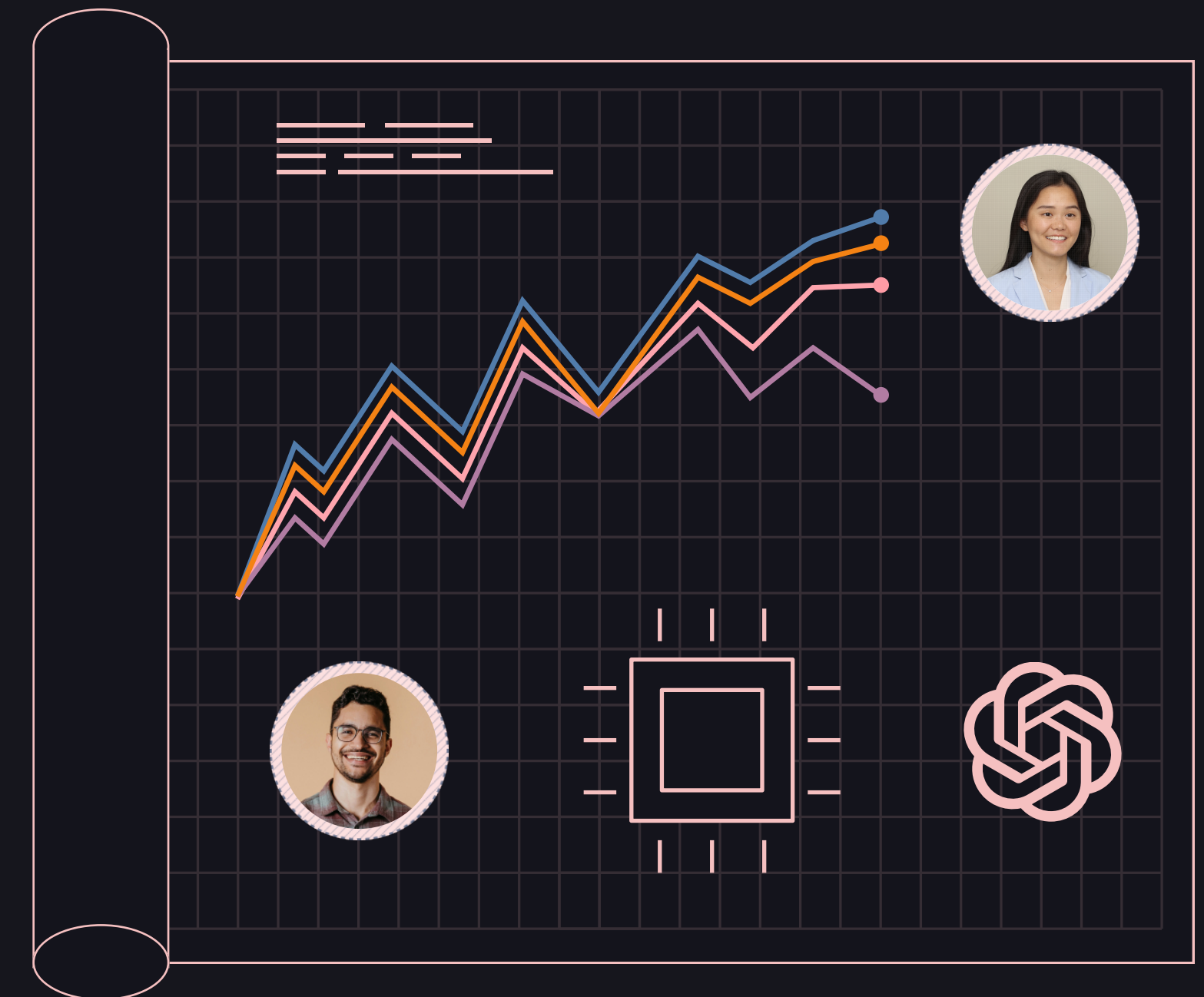
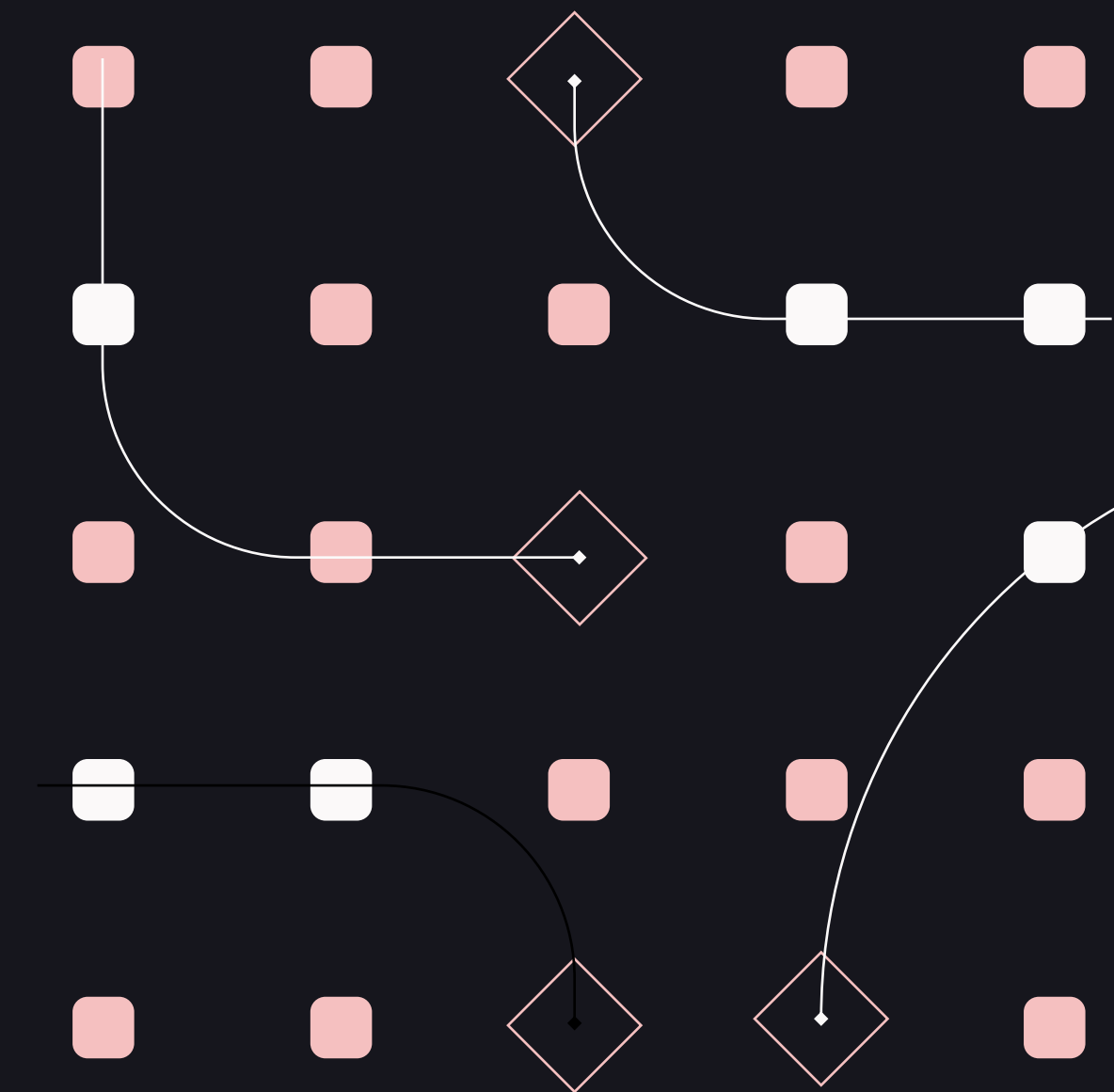


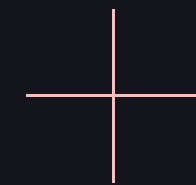
Table of Contents

1. Map data projects, builders, and stakeholders
2. Map user groups
3. Map data sources
4. A few easy ways to continue governance in Hex
5. More resources



STEP 1:

Map data projects, builders, and stakeholders



01

Identify your builders and stakeholders, and the most common workflows your team(s) will be building.

Take a moment to fill out some examples of anticipated data workflows.

[illegible]

STEP 2:

Map user groups

02

Use the table above to map users into groups, and define which groups get access to which data projects.

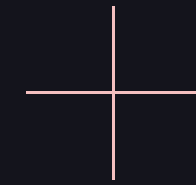
This will help you and your team identify what groups to grant access certain datasets, pipelines, reports, and apps to.

Take a moment to fill out some anticipated data project groups.

Group	Who is included?
Data Team	All Admin seats
Product Analytics Team	PMs (Editor access), others who are on the Product Analytics team
User Funnel Project	All folks involved in the User Funnel project. Could be Data folks, PMs, Marketing, etc

STEP 3:

Map data sources permissions



03

For each key workflow, identify where the data comes from, who needs access, and which sources require tighter controls.

Planning data access by role and source

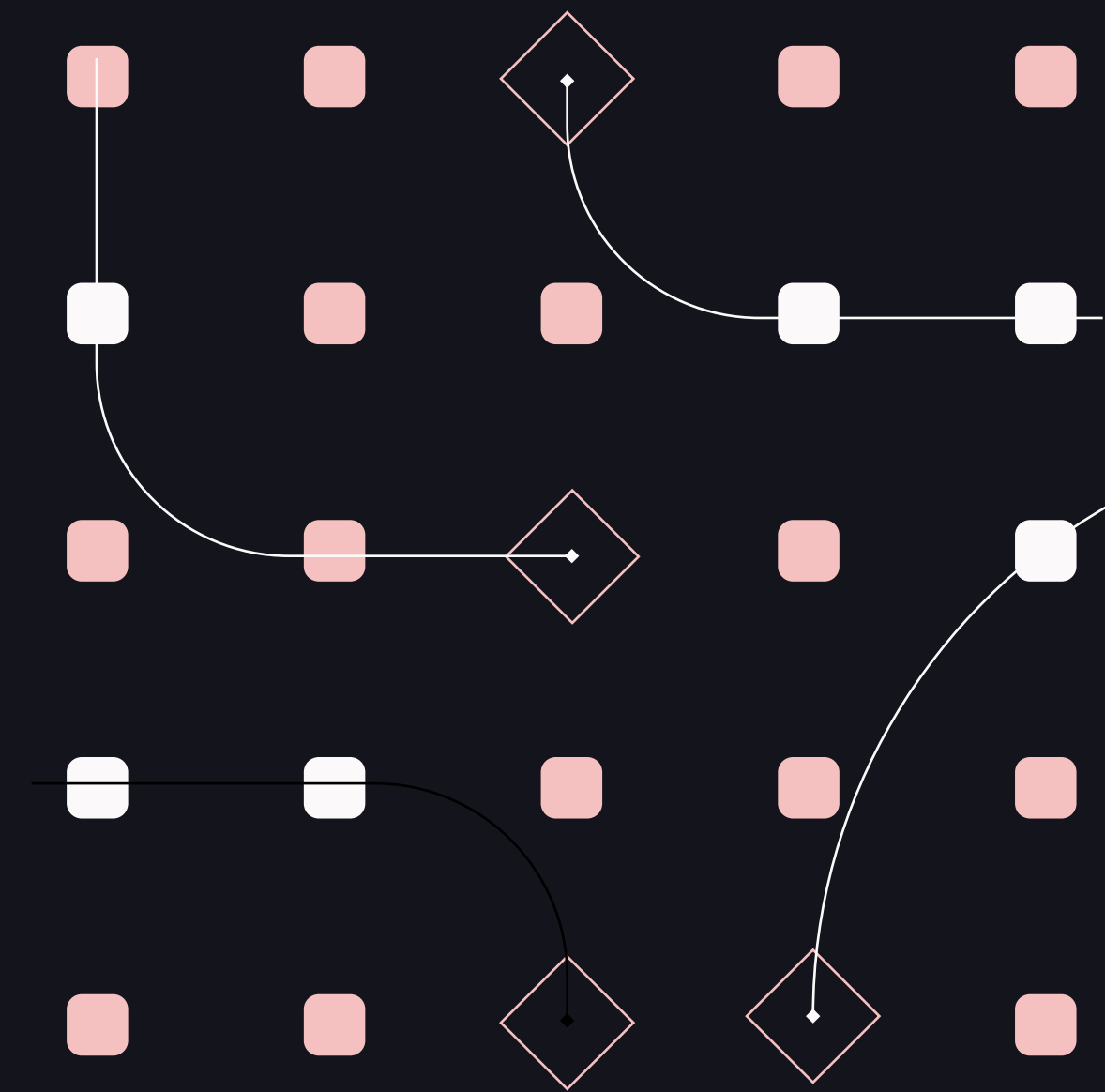
Data practitioners usually have full access to the entire warehouse, while business users typically work within curated environments limited to “production-ready” datasets.

These environments are governed by different permission levels — set both within the data warehouse and in your tools— to ensure the right people access the right data.

Data source	Can query	Can view
Data source 1: Snowflake Dev	Data Team	Company
Data source 2: Snowflake Prod	Company	Company
Data source 3: Snowflake w/ HR data	Data Team w/ PII permissions	HR
Data source 4:		
Data source 5:		

A few easy ways to continue governance in Hex

to help with project lifecycle

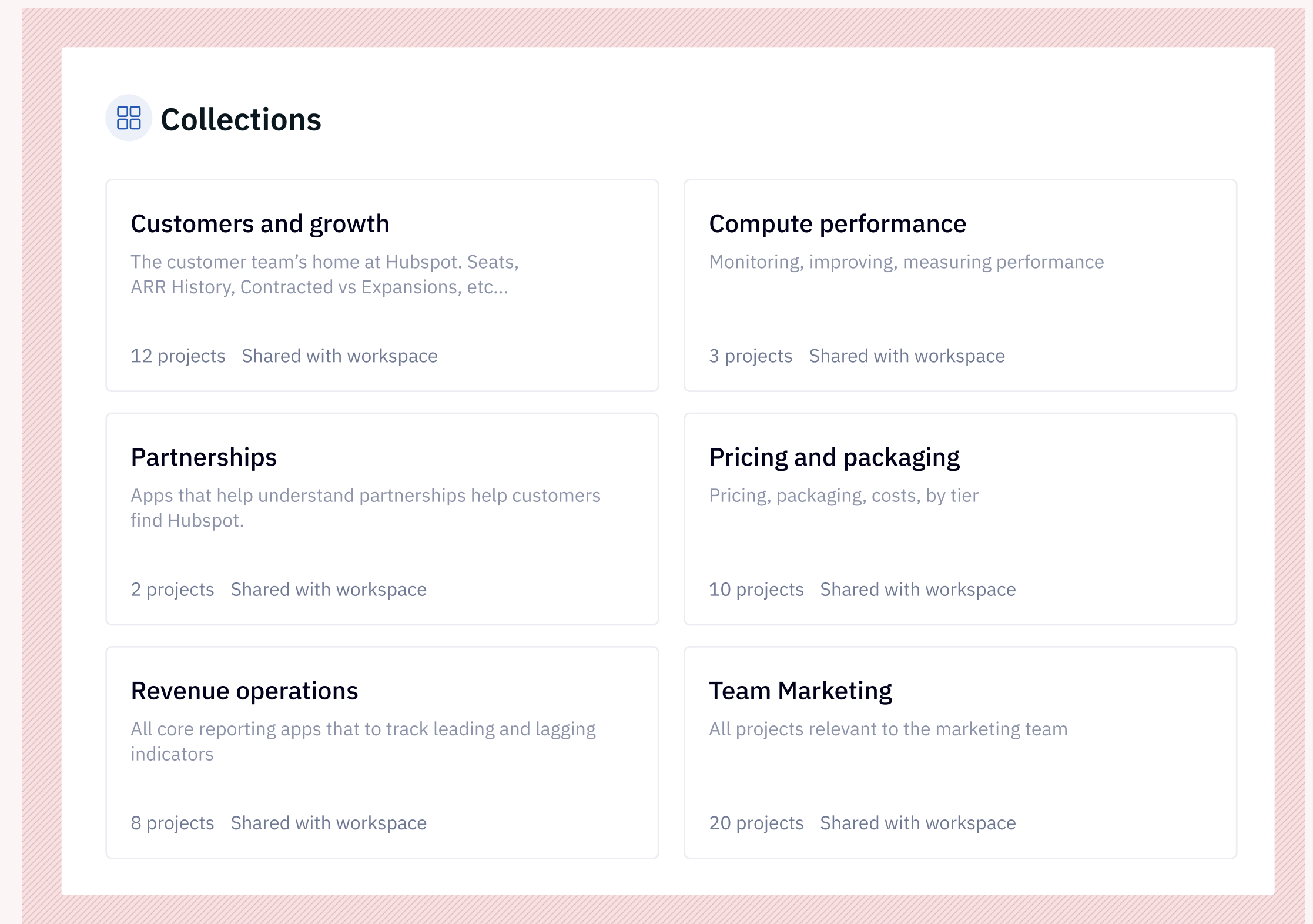


Ways we make it easier to organize data in Hex

Collections

Collections are a way to have 1 to many groupings of your data projects in Hex. Unlike a traditional file directory, Hex projects can live in multiple collections. This allows for flexible organization structures that mimic how data teams work and prevent projects getting siloed with the wrong level of access.

At Hex we created collections for both Teams and Themes. For example: When a project is ready to be shared, it gets organized into a collection based on its team (who it's "for") and theme (what cross-functional insights it includes).



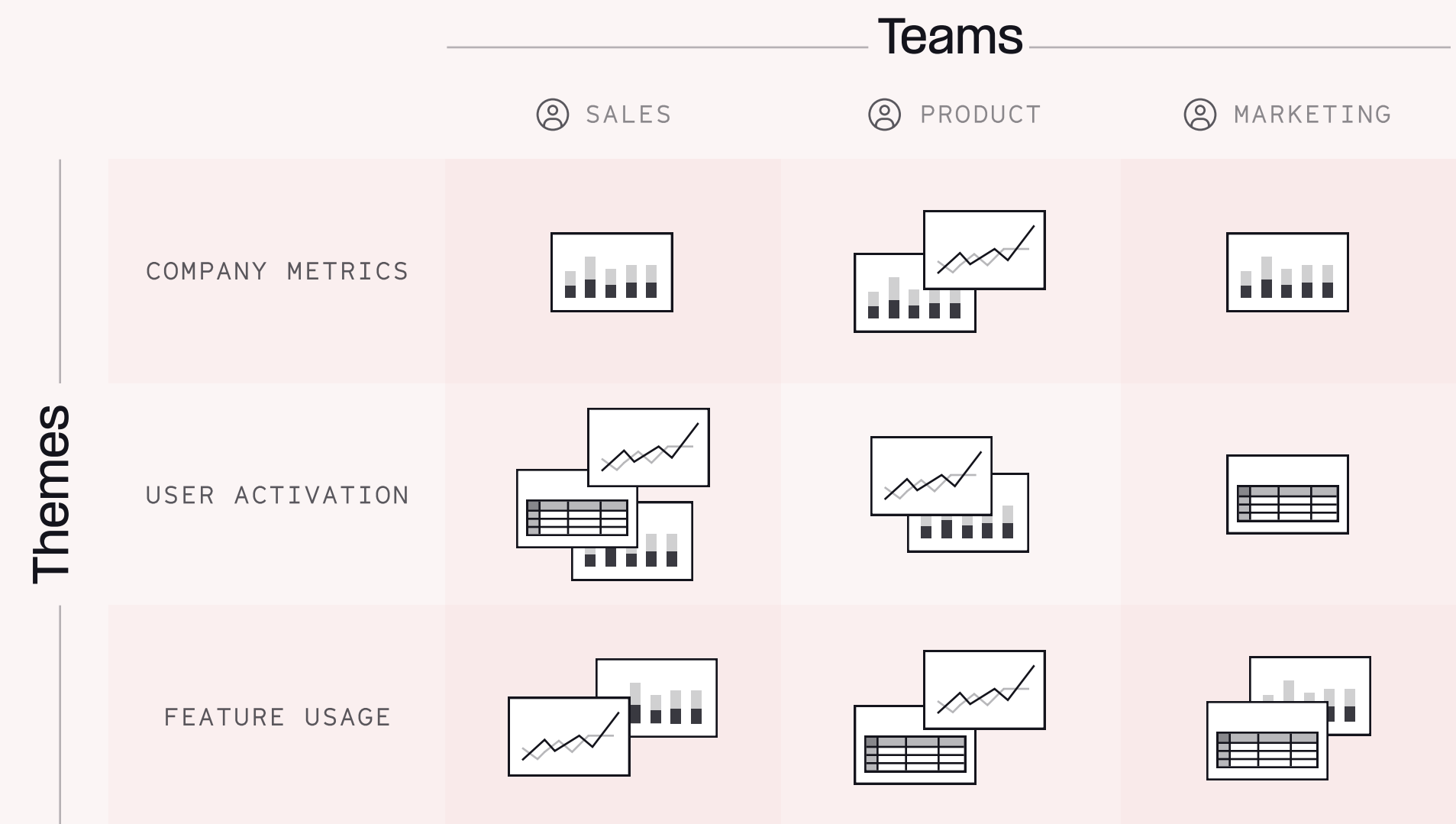
At Hex we orient around “Teams and Themes” as the scaffolding to guild your Hex workspace organization.

Teams

Groups of folks within the same team that have common mandates and goals (e.g., data team, sales team)

Themes

Represent an area of focus or a cross functional initiative (e.g., user activation or feature usage).



Refer back to your chart for the most common workflows in your data tool (slide 5) and the builders/stakeholders of those. Can you use that to zoom out and identify the Teams and Themes most relevant to your company?

Themes	Teams
Product adoption	Data Team
User activation	Data Team, Marketing
...	...

Themes	Teams

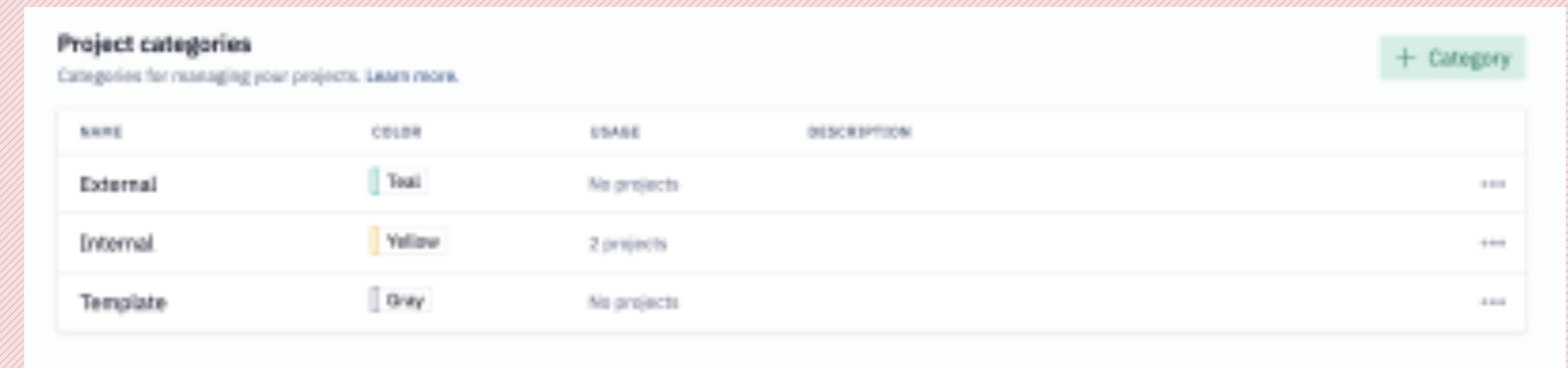
Categories

Categories are labels that can be applied at the project-level. A project can have more than one category!

Categories can be used to group and find projects, components, and data objects within your workspace.

Additionally, you can include categories that denote things like:

- the type of analysis in the project/component (e.g., "Model Development," "Static Dashboard," "A/B Test")
- data classifications (e.g., 'Internal Only', 'Experimental', 'Confidential', "PII")



Project categories
Categories for managing your projects, learn more.

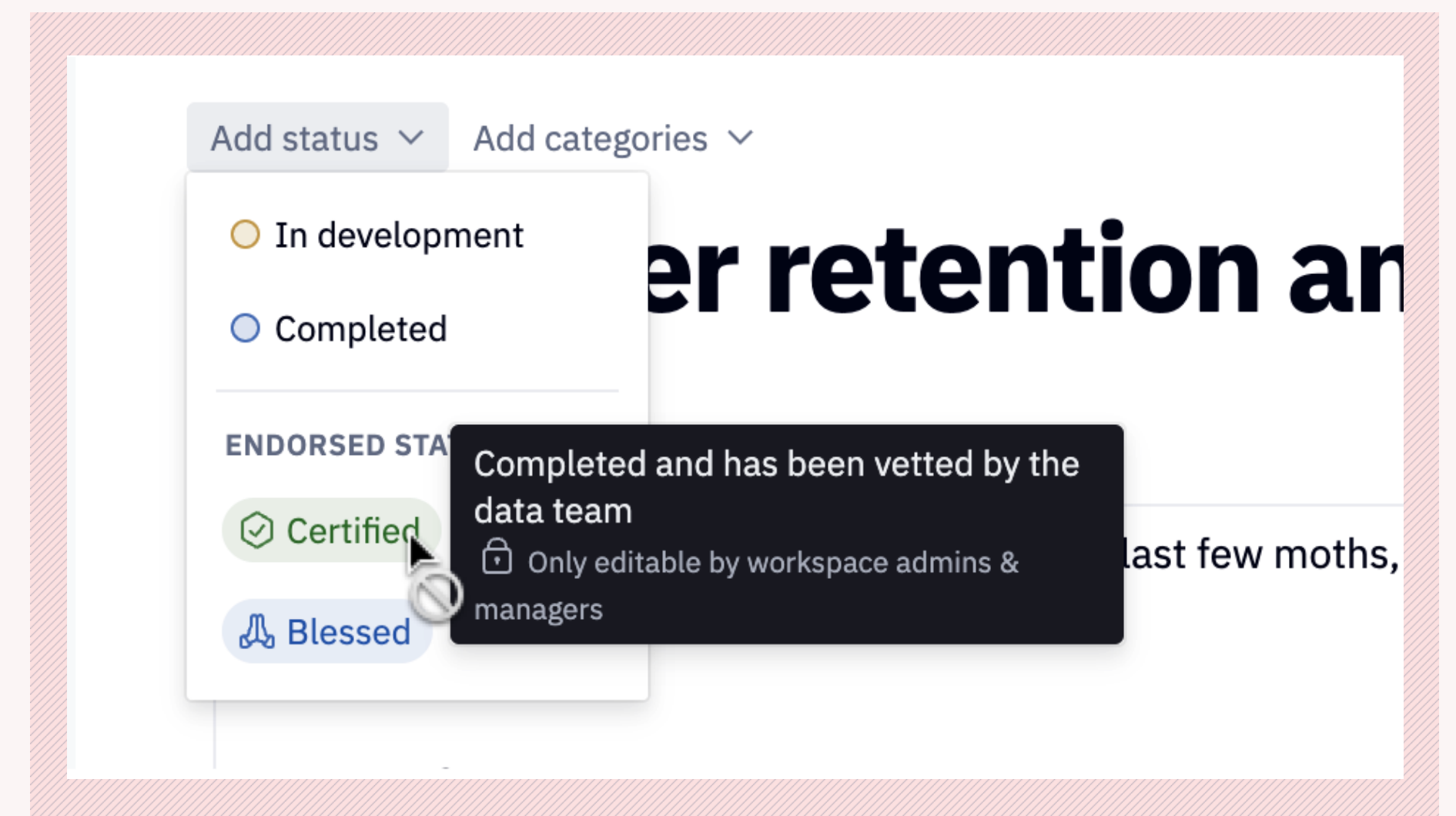
[+ Category](#)

NAME	COLOR	USAGE	DESCRIPTION
External	Teal	No projects	View
Internal	Yellow	2 projects	View
Template	Gray	No projects	View

Statuses

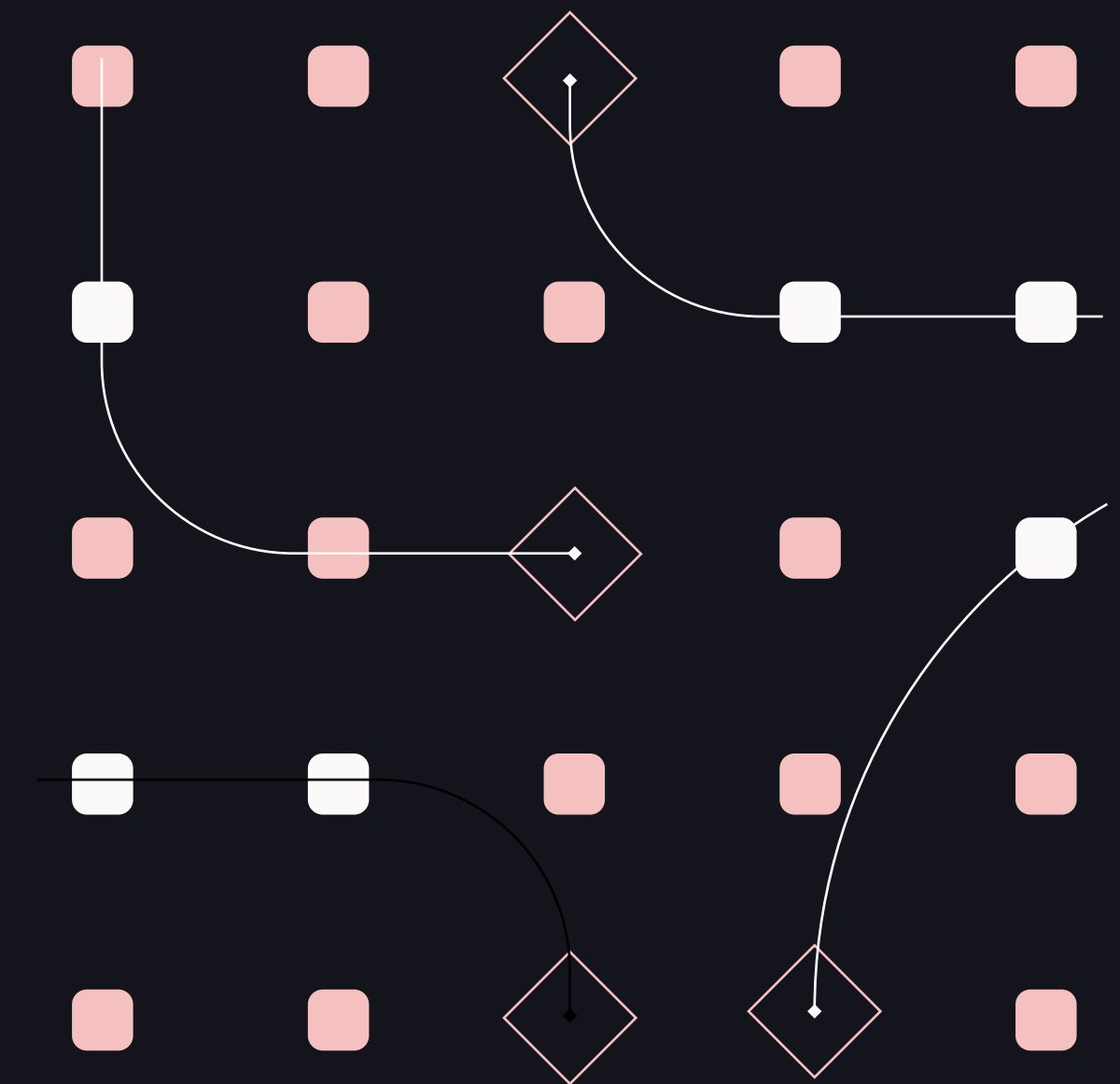
Statuses are labels that can be used to indicate quality or intended usage to other members of your workspace. Only one status can be applied per object.

Endorsed Statuses are customizable and indicate that a project, component, or data object has been endorsed for wider use.

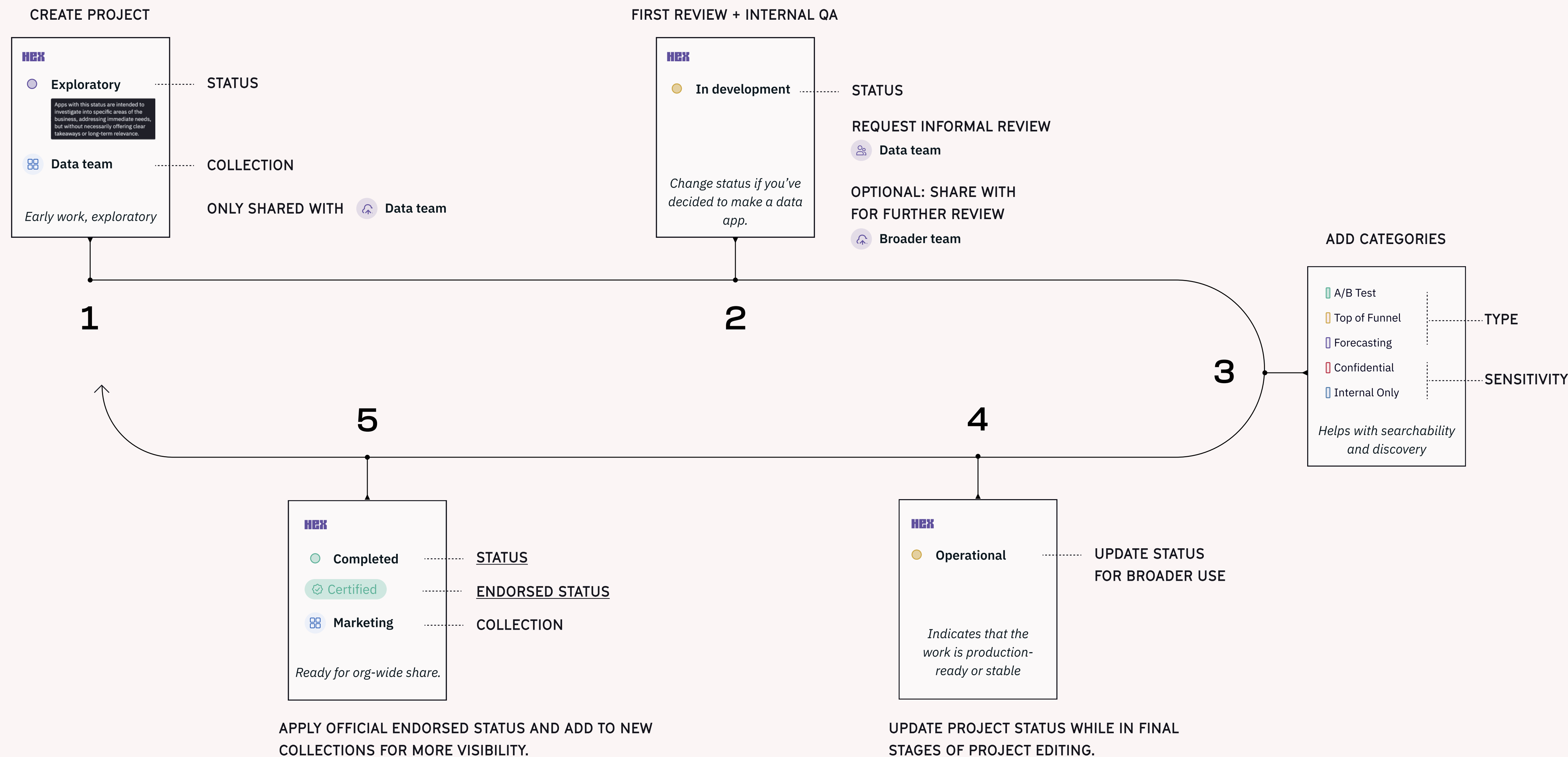


Project lifecycle

The last piece of this puzzle is planning for how things change!



Data Project Lifecycle in Hex



Project lifecycle

A common pattern is to start data work as in “development.” Work in this stage should be shared only with the immediate team of analysts. Once the work is deemed “good” it then gets promoted to “production.” Use Statuses to label projects accordingly.

Endorsed Statuses + Reviews

So how can you manage the natural evolution from dev to prod? Hex has the concept of an “Endorsed status” to indicate which projects have reached the lofty goal of being ‘trusted’. Our Review process can also be used in this process (either optionally or by requirement) to make sure the right eyes are reviewing work before it goes out to the whole company!

For example

- Specify that a piece of content-- projects, components, data connections-- can be trusted with an Endorsed status (e.g., "Trusted," "Reviewed," "Approved," "Prioritized")
- If desired, for content that's mission critical or to which changes would have big impacts (e.g., a component imported into many projects), require a review to apply an Endorsed status.

Questions to consider:

- What are the phases of your data projects and their circulation that you can mirror as Hex statuses?
- Which should be considered Endorsed?
- Which might you want to gate behind a required Review?

What are the phases of your data projects and their circulation that you can mirror as Hex statuses? Which should be considered Endorsed? Which might you want to gate behind a required Review?

		Endorsed?	Require reviews?
WIP	- projects that are working toward productionalizaion, however are not yet ready for prime time		
Ad hoc	- one-off analyses that might never see the “stamp of approval” to become production apps		
Trusted	- analyses based on trusted data that other users can rely on to be accurate	✓	
Production	- trusted, verified, and approved data insights that the entire team can count on	✓	✓

Don't forget that you can also move projects between Collections to mirror these different phases of the data lifecycle! Maybe projects are added to "Dev" collections to start and then moved into "Prod" collections once approved.

Required Reviews can be used as gates to ensure that not only is the content of the Hex project itself accurate and reliable, but also that projects are adhering to the project lifecycle practices for your team. For example, to approve a review it could required that the project is also added to the appropriate Collections and without that, the review is not approved.

Archiving

Clean up cruft in your workspace by turning on Auto Archiving! Individual scratchpads are a critical piece of how developers work with data. But let's not leave those lying about once they're not needed! You can configure thresholds for how recently a project has been viewed or edited and automatically archive those so that they don't clutter up your workspace.

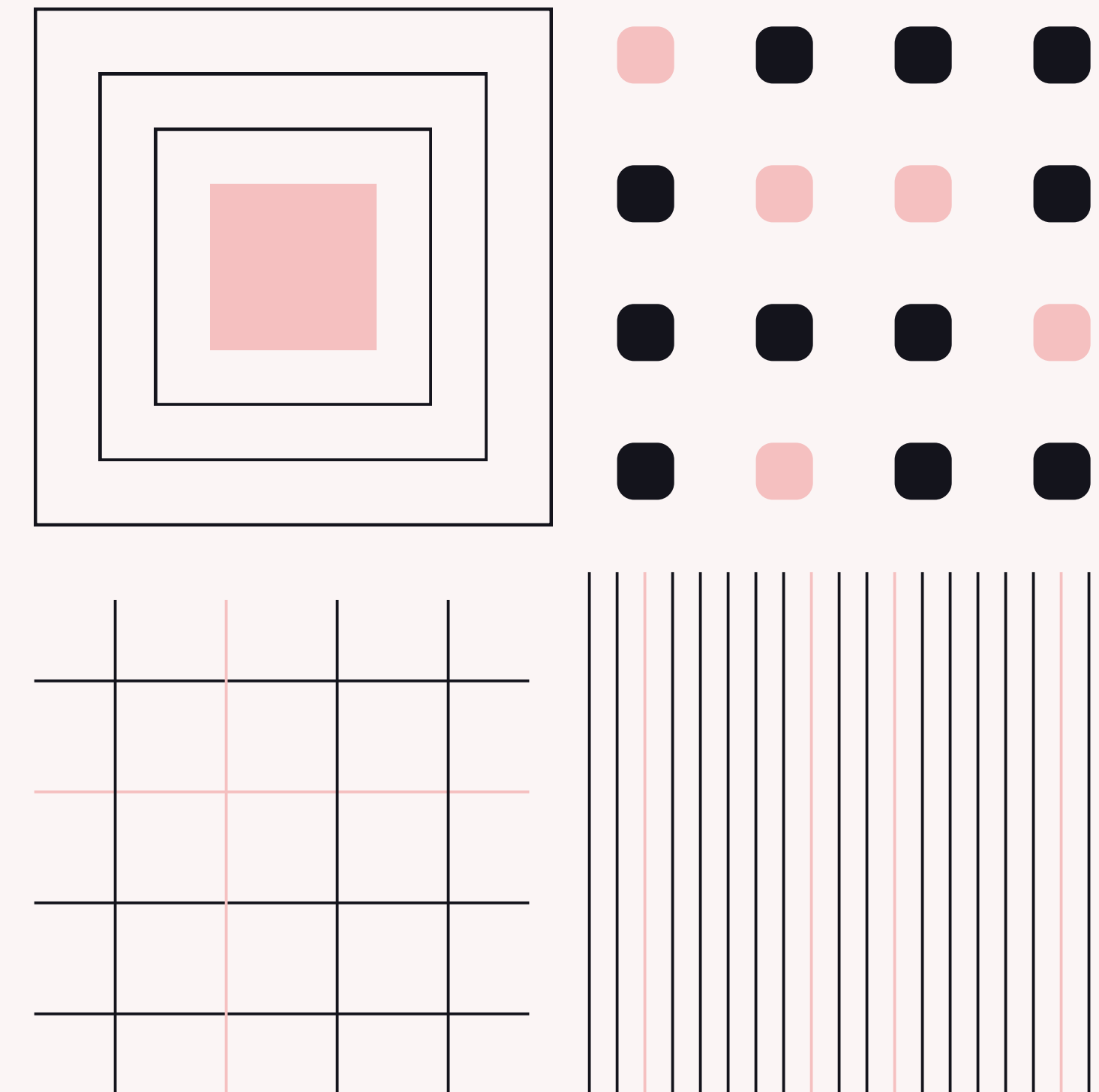


Birds—eye view

But how can you, an Admin in your workspace, see if the processes you’ve painstakingly outlined are being followed?

Hex has a Swiss-Army-Knife-like view of all of your workspace projects in the “Projects” tab of your homepage. From here you can filter projects by a ton of different attributes and also make bulk changes.

If you want to build more data-driven ways to curate your projects, check out the ListProjects API endpoint. With this endpoint you can filter through and identify projects that aren’t adhering to your internal best practices (e.g., published projects with a certain status/category that aren’t included in a category) so that you can audit adherence and touch base with folks as needed.



More governance content

- [How data leaders are investing in data governance and semantic layers](#)
- [How to prepare your data strategy for LLMs](#)
- [How HubSpot scales data trust across 8,000 employees](#)

Let Hex help you structure and scale what you've already built.

[Schedule a demo call](#)

or

[Get started on Hex for free](#)